

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 891

By Gardenhire

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the 251st anniversary of the Battles of Lexington and Concord.

WHEREAS, the Sons of the American Revolution are celebrating the 251st anniversary of the founding of America and have proclaimed 2023 to 2033 as the "Decade of the American Revolution"; and

WHEREAS, on April 19, 2026, the nation will commemorate the 251st anniversary of the Battles of Lexington and Concord, the "Shot Heard Round the World," that began the Revolutionary War and united the colonies in the cause of liberty and independence; and

WHEREAS, all cities, counties, and states are encouraged to join in this patriotic celebration to remember the sacrifices of all who supported the revolutionary cause and who participated in establishing the United States of America; and

WHEREAS, in 1775, patriots in Massachusetts squared off against the British army to defend our freedoms when the British Commander General Thomas Gage ordered his troops to march to Concord and seize its arms; and

WHEREAS, the British force marched through the night, and on the morning of April 19, 1775, they arrived at Lexington Green, where they were met by a contingent of eighty Lexington militiamen, known as Minutemen, composed of local farmers, tradesmen, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, it is unclear who fired the first shot, but a skirmish ensued, during which eight militia were killed and one British soldier wounded. After restoring order, the British resumed the march to Concord; and

WHEREAS, militia from throughout the region converged to meet the British in a battle fought at Concord's North Bridge. As the British retreated for Boston, a running battle ensued in which ninety-five Patriots and 273 British were killed; and

WHEREAS, the Battles of Lexington and Concord roused New Englanders to join forces and lay siege to Boston, showing that citizen soldiers could stand up to the British army and leading many formerly neutral colonists to support resistance; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we join with the Sons of the American Revolution and other patriotic, community, and veterans' organizations on April 19, 2026, to commemorate the Battles of Lexington and Concord, important events in the history of our great country.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.